QUANTUS INSIGHTS

STATEWIDE SURVEY OF LIKELY VOTERS · GENERAL ELECTION

Texas U.S. Senate Survey

The Paxton–Talarico U.S. Senate ballot, three weeks before Election Day.

FIELDED	RESPONDENTS	POPULATION	MARGIN OF ERROR
October 9–11, 2026	854	Likely voters	±3.6

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Core findings

47.2 – 46.7

Paxton – Talarico, U.S. Senate ballot

01

A Paxton edge too small to read

Paxton 47.2 percent to Talarico 46.7, a 0.5-point edge. The margin of error on the gap between two candidates is about ±7.2, so neither holds a measurable lead. 3.9 percent are undecided and Ted Brown, the Libertarian, draws 2.2.

02

A gender, age and metro divide

Women favor Talarico 52 to 42; men favor Paxton 53 to 41. Voters under 45 go Talarico; voters 65 and over go Paxton 56 to 39. Urban voters go 60 Talarico; rural voters go 64 Paxton; the suburbs are 50 Paxton to 45.

03

Independents and Hispanic voters lean Talarico

Independents go 52 Talarico to 37, with 9 percent undecided. White voters go Paxton 59 to 36; Hispanic voters go Talarico 55 to 37; Black voters 82 to 10. Republicans hold at 87 percent, Democrats at 95.

04

Paxton underwater, Talarico narrowly positive

Paxton is 45.8 favorable to 51.8 unfavorable, net -6.0; 46.2 percent are very unfavorable. Talarico is 48.6 to 46.8, net +1.8, with strong views split 37 to 37; 4.6 percent have never heard of him or hold no opinion.

05

The sample recalls a Trump +10 state

Respondents recall a 51.5 to 41.1 Trump vote, a 10.4-point margin, against a certified 13.7. The sample leans Republican in its recalled vote; the ballot sits about ten points to the left of it and eight points left of Cruz's 2024 margin.

METHODOLOGY

How this survey was conducted

POPULATION

The survey represents likely voters in the 2026 Texas general election. A likely-voter screen was used to define and weight the survey population, drawing on voting history, demographics, partisan-lean indicators and voter-file geography. Weighting benchmarks were constructed from the voter-file research universe so that every target reflects the actual composition of Texas's likely electorate.

FIELD PERIOD

October 9 to October 11, 2026.

SAMPLING

Stratified random sampling from the eligible universe, matched to available contact records.

MARGIN OF ERROR

±3.6 percentage points at the 95 percent confidence level, design-adjusted, for the full sample of 854. The design effect is 1.18, resulting in an effective sample size of approximately 724. Subgroup margins are larger. The margin on the difference between two candidates is roughly twice the single-share margin, about ±7.2. Uncertainty was additionally checked with 400 reraked bootstrap replicates across seven analytical scenarios.

ROUNDING

Percentages may not total 100 due to rounding. Full precision is retained in the underlying results.

UNIVERSE

Active registered Texas voter-file records. Respondents were contacted through SMS invitations sent to mobile phones. Of 854 completed interviews, 15 respondents (1.8 percent) who said they would not vote were removed, leaving a voters-only base of 839 for the ballot and every question that follows it.

MODE

SMS-to-mobile cell interviews.

WEIGHTING

Iterative proportional fitting, or raking, to benchmarks for the Texas likely general-election electorate on six dimensions: sex, age range, race and ethnicity (modeled), education (modeled), metro type and media market. Weights were trimmed to limit the influence of individual respondents and renormalized each iteration.

REPORTING

Topline results are shown to one decimal; crosstab cells are whole-number column percentages within each subgroup. Base n is shown on every table. Cells marked † rest on fewer than 80 respondents and are directional only. Race, ethnicity and education are modeled from the voter file; party is the mapped voter-file party field. The fourteen smallest media markets are combined into a rest-of-state column.

The survey intelligence pipeline that processes each study is described on the next page. For questions or inquiries email contact@quantusinsights.org or visit quantusinsights.org.

QUANTUS INSIGHTS

METHODOLOGY

Survey intelligence pipeline

Quantus Insights processes each study through a multi-stage survey intelligence pipeline that evaluates sample composition, coverage, geographic balance, and statistical stability.

01

BENCHMARKS AND WEIGHTS

The pipeline applies the study's likely-voter criteria and weighting benchmarks, monitors the distribution and influence of survey weights, and evaluates convergence with the intended electorate.

02

RESPONSE-BIAS AUDIT

Because respondents are drawn from the voter file, the pipeline also audits who within each demographic, partisan and geographic cell responded, comparing reported prior-cycle vote against certified results to detect response bias that demographic raking cannot.

03

CALIBRATION AND STABILITY

Where indicated, final weights are calibrated to official prior-cycle returns at the media-market level; calibration targets come from certified election results, never from the survey's own recall distribution. Effective sample size, subgroup stability, missing-data patterns and response-propensity checks against the universe are reviewed throughout.

04

EXPERT OVERSIGHT

Statistical automation is paired with expert methodological oversight to validate data quality, confirm the appropriate use of variables and benchmarks, and identify irregularities requiring further review. This combination provides a rigorous and consistent framework for producing estimates representative of the defined survey population.

How this study was processed: the pipeline's checks run on the full reporting base of 854 before any result in this report is produced. The reported design effect of 1.18 and effective sample size of 724 are outputs of that review.

QUANTUS INSIGHTS

SAMPLE COMPOSITION

Reporting composition

854
reporting base

GENDER	%	
Women	52.7	n=450
Men	47.3	n=404

AGE	%	
18–29	10.4	n=89
30–44	23.1	n=197
45–64	36.5	n=312
65+	30.0	n=256

RACE / ETHNICITY	%	
White	57.7	n=493
Hispanic	24.9	n=213
Black	10.7	n=91
Asian	4.3	n=37
Other	2.3	n=20

EDUCATION (MODELED)	%	
HS – Some College	58.9	n=503
College	26.3	n=225
Graduate School	14.8	n=126

PARTY ID (MODELED)	%	
Republican	44.6	n=381
Democrat	34.8	n=297
Independent	20.6	n=176

METRO TYPE	%	
Urban	34.5	n=295
Suburban	37.8	n=323
Rural	21.1	n=180
Town	6.6	n=56

MEDIA MARKET	%	
Dallas–Ft. Worth	31.1	n=266
Houston	23.5	n=201
Austin	10.4	n=89
San Antonio	10.3	n=88
Waco–Temple–Bryan	4.2	n=36
Tyler–Longview	2.6	n=22
Rest of state (14 markets)	17.8	n=152

Counts are the full reporting base of 854; the ballot and every following question use the voters-only base of 839 (15 would-not-vote respondents removed). Weights are raked to the methodology benchmarks. Party is modeled from the voter file and runs 45 Republican, 35 Democrat, 21 independent.

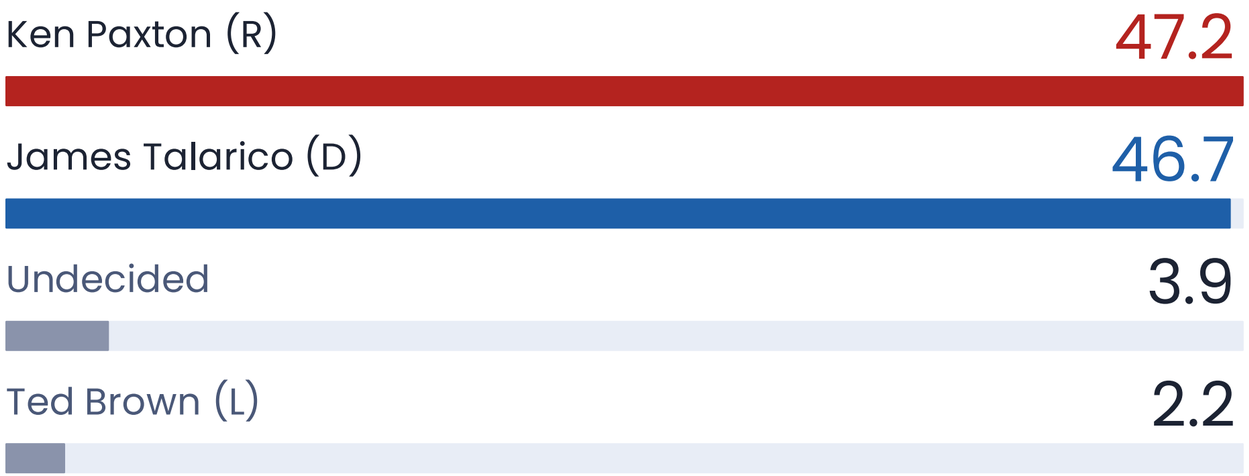
The six largest media markets carry 82 percent of the sample; the fourteen remaining markets (Harlingen, El Paso, Beaumont, Amarillo, Corpus Christi, Odessa, Lubbock, Abilene, Shreveport, Wichita Falls, Laredo, San Angelo, Sherman and Victoria) are combined as rest of state. Town (n=56), Waco–Temple–Bryan (n=36), Tyler–Longview (n=19), Other (n=19) and Asian (n=36) respondents rest on fewer than 80 in the crosstabs that follow and are directional.

TOPLINE SUMMARY

The ballot at a glance

Responses to the U.S. Senate ballot and the perceived vote of respondents' friends, family, coworkers and neighbors, in percent of likely voters. Full results and demographic detail follow.

Q1 · U.S. SENATE BALLOT · N=839



Q1 · TWO-WAY AND MARGIN

As asked, all likely voters (Q1)	Paxton +0.5
Two-way share, Paxton	50.3
Two-way share, Talarico	49.7
Undecided, as asked	3.9

Q2 · THE PEOPLE YOU KNOW · N=839

Almost all or mostly Paxton	43.1
Almost all or mostly Talarico	41.7
Not sure	10.6
About evenly split	4.5

N = 839 likely voters who would vote · October 9–11, 2026 · design-adjusted margin of error ±3.6. Percentages may not total 100 due to rounding. Two-way shares divide each nominee's vote by the two-candidate total. Q4 combines "almost all" and "mostly" responses for each nominee.

SECTION ONE

The U.S. Senate ballot

The Paxton–Talarico ballot with demographic and media-market detail, and how respondents expect the people around them to vote.

QUESTIONS

Q1, Q4

STRUCTURE

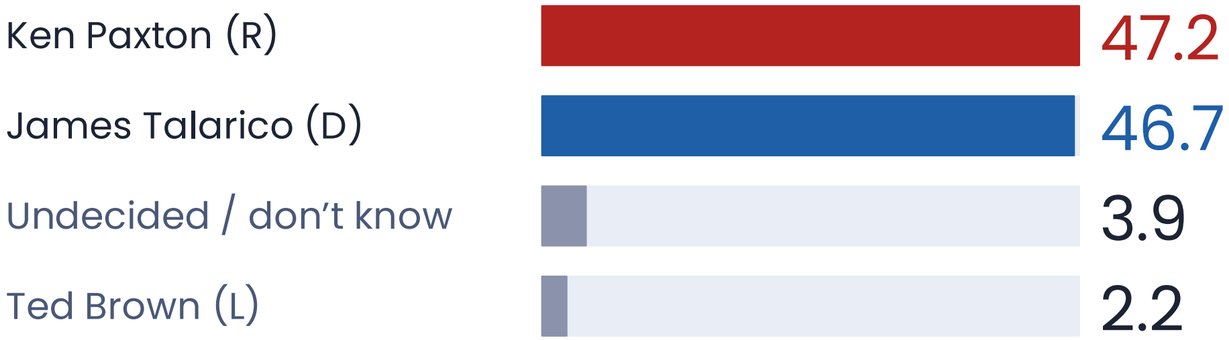
Topline result, demographic and media-market detail

BASES

n = 839 voters-only base

Q1 · U.S. SENATE BALLOT

If the election for U.S. Senate in Texas were held today, who would you vote for?



Paxton +0.5

Paxton margin, full sample

TWO-WAY SHARE



0.5 point margin, Paxton, two-way

MARGIN BY GROUP

Women	Talarico +10
Men	Paxton +12
Independents	Talarico +15
Suburban	Paxton +5
Rural	Paxton +34

THE MARGIN

Paxton leads by 0.5 points. The margin on a difference between two candidates is about ±7.2, so the result is a statistical tie.

THE REST OF THE BALLOT

Ted Brown, the Libertarian, draws 2.2 percent; 3.9 percent are undecided. The 15 respondents who would not vote are excluded from the base.

REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the voters-only base of 839. Group margins are differences in whole-number column percentages; two-way share divides each nominee by the two-candidate total.

Q1 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

If the election for U.S. Senate in Texas were held today, who would you vote for?

GROUP	PAXTON	TALARICO	UNDEC.	N
GENDER				
Women	42	52	5	443
Men	53	41	3	396
AGE				
18–29	29	62	6	87
30–44	40	53	4	192
45–64	49	45	4	307
65+	56	39	3	253
RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)				
White	59	36	2	485
Hispanic	37	55	7	210
Black	10	82	6	89
Other†	46†	50†	4†	19
Asian†	38†	51†	5†	36

GROUP	PAXTON	TALARICO	UNDEC.	N
EDUCATION (MODELED)				
HS – Some College	52	43	4	492
College	43	51	4	223
Graduate School	36	56	5	124
PARTY ID (MODELED)				
Republican	87	7	3	376
Democrat	2	95	2	293
Independent	37	52	9	170
METRO TYPE				
Urban	34	60	4	287
Suburban	50	45	2	320
Rural	64	30	5	176
Town†	49†	38†	8†	56

MEDIA MARKET	PAXTON	TALARICO	UNDEC.	N
MEDIA MARKET				
Dallas–Ft. Worth	45	49	3	263
Houston	46	49	4	199
Austin	40	57	0	89
San Antonio	48	49	3	86
Waco–Temple–Bryan†	48†	32†	13†	36
Tyler–Longview†	61†	24†	9†	19
Rest of state	54	38	7	147

GENDER AND AGE

Women back Talarico by 10 points; men back Paxton by 12. Voters under 30 go Talarico by 33 and 30 to 44 by 13; voters 45 to 64 go Paxton by 4 and 65 and over by 17.

PARTY AND PLACE

Independents go 52 Talarico to 37, 9 percent undecided. Republicans hold at 87 percent, Democrats at 95. Urban voters go Talarico by 26, rural voters Paxton by 34; the suburbs are Paxton +5.

REPORTING NOTE

Whole-number column percentages. Brown not shown. † = base under 80, directional; race, education and party are modeled from the voter file. Rest of state combines the fourteen smallest markets.

Q1 · MEDIA MARKET DETAIL

The Senate ballot by media market: the six largest markets and the rest of the state.

Q1 · U.S. SENATE BALLOT

MEDIA MARKET	N	PAXTON	TALARICO	UNDECIDED	BROWN	MARGIN	2024 SENATE
Dallas–Ft. Worth	n=263	45	49	3	3	Talarico +4	R +6.4
Houston	n=199	46	49	4	1	Talarico +3	R +3.9
Austin	n=89	40	57	0	3	Talarico +17	D +18.2
San Antonio	n=86	48	49	3	1	Talarico +1	R +3.1
Waco–Temple–Bryan†	n=36	48†	32†	13†	7†	Paxton +16†	R +26.7
Tyler–Longview (Lfkn & Ncgd)†	n=19	61†	24†	9†	6†	Paxton +37†	R +48.9
Rest of state (14 markets combined)	n=147	54	38	7	1	Paxton +16	R +26.4

DALLAS AND HOUSTON

Dallas–Ft. Worth, 31 percent of the ballot base, goes Talarico 49 to 45; Houston, 24 percent, 49 to 46. Both markets went for Cruz in 2024, by 6.4 and 3.9 points. Austin goes Talarico 57 to 40.

THE SMALLER MARKETS

San Antonio is even at 49 Talarico to 48. Waco–Temple–Bryan goes Paxton 48 to 32 and Tyler–Longview 61 to 24, both on bases under 80. The rest of the state goes Paxton 54 to 38.

REPORTING NOTE

Whole-number column percentages within each market. † = base under 80, directional. Rest of state combines the fourteen smallest markets, 147 respondents together. 2024 Senate is the certified Cruz–Allred margin.

Q2 · THE PEOPLE YOU KNOW

Thinking about the people you know, who do you think most of them will vote for in the Senate race?

Paxton +1.4

network margin, almost all plus mostly



LEANING PAXTON VS. LEANING TALARICO



Paxton 43.1 Talarico 41.7

1.4 point margin, Paxton networks over Talarico networks

NETWORK MARGIN BY GROUP

Women	Talarico +10
Men	Paxton +15
Independents	Talarico +24
Suburban	Talarico +1
Rural	Paxton +44

A MIRROR OF THE BALLOT

43.1 percent expect the people around them to vote mostly or almost all for Paxton; 41.7 percent say Talarico. The 1.4-point gap matches the ballot's 0.5 within rounding.

WHERE NETWORKS DIFFER

Independents see their circles going Talarico by 24, wider than their own 15-point lean. Rural voters see Paxton networks by 44; urban voters see Talarico by 25. The suburbs are split, 42 to 41.

REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the voters-only base of 839. Leaning totals combine almost all and mostly for each nominee; group margins are differences in whole-number column percentages.

Q4 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

Thinking about the people you know, who do you think most of them will vote for in the Senate race?

GROUP	PAX.	TAL.	UNSURE	SPLIT	N
GENDER					
Women	39	49	8	4	442
Men	48	33	14	5	397
AGE					
18–29	23	67	6	6	87
30–44	33	50	10	8	194
45–64	46	41	11	3	307
65+	56	29	12	4	251
RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)					
White	52	31	12	5	484
Hispanic	32	53	11	4	209
Black	24	69	3	5	90
Other†	17†	66†	14†	2†	20
Asian†	55†	36†	6†	4†	36

GROUP	PAX.	TAL.	UNSURE	SPLIT	N
EDUCATION (MODELED)					
HS – Some College	49	34	13	4	494
College	37	50	9	5	221
Graduate School	31	59	6	5	124
PARTY ID (MODELED)					
Republican	80	8	10	3	374
Democrat	5	80	10	5	292
Independent	27	51	14	8	173
METRO TYPE					
Urban	32	57	8	3	290
Suburban	41	42	13	4	317
Rural	64	20	8	8	177
Town†	51†	28†	17†	4†	55

MEDIA MARKET	PAX.	TAL.	UNSURE	SPLIT	N
MEDIA MARKET					
Dallas–Ft. Worth	37	43	10	10	261
Houston	45	44	9	2	197
Austin	31	58	10	2	87
San Antonio	44	42	14	0	86
Waco–Temple–Bryan†	43†	28†	18†	11†	35
Tyler–Longview†	60†	18†	17†	6†	22
Rest of state	57	34	9	0	151

GENDER AND AGE

Women see their circles going Talarico 49 to 39; men see Paxton 48 to 33. Voters under 30 see Talarico networks 67 to 23; voters 65 and over see Paxton 56 to 29.

PARTY AND PLACE

Republicans see Paxton circles 80 to 8; Democrats see Talarico 80 to 5. Independents see Talarico 51 to 27, with 14 percent unsure. Rural voters see Paxton 64 to 20; urban voters see Talarico 57 to 32.

REPORTING NOTE

Whole-number column percentages. Paxton and Talarico each combine almost all and mostly. † = base under 80. Rest of state combines the fourteen smallest markets.

SECTION TWO

Texas in context

The Senate ballot against the state’s regional map, its statewide benchmarks since 2008 and the published polling averages.

QUESTIONS

Q1 in context

STRUCTURE

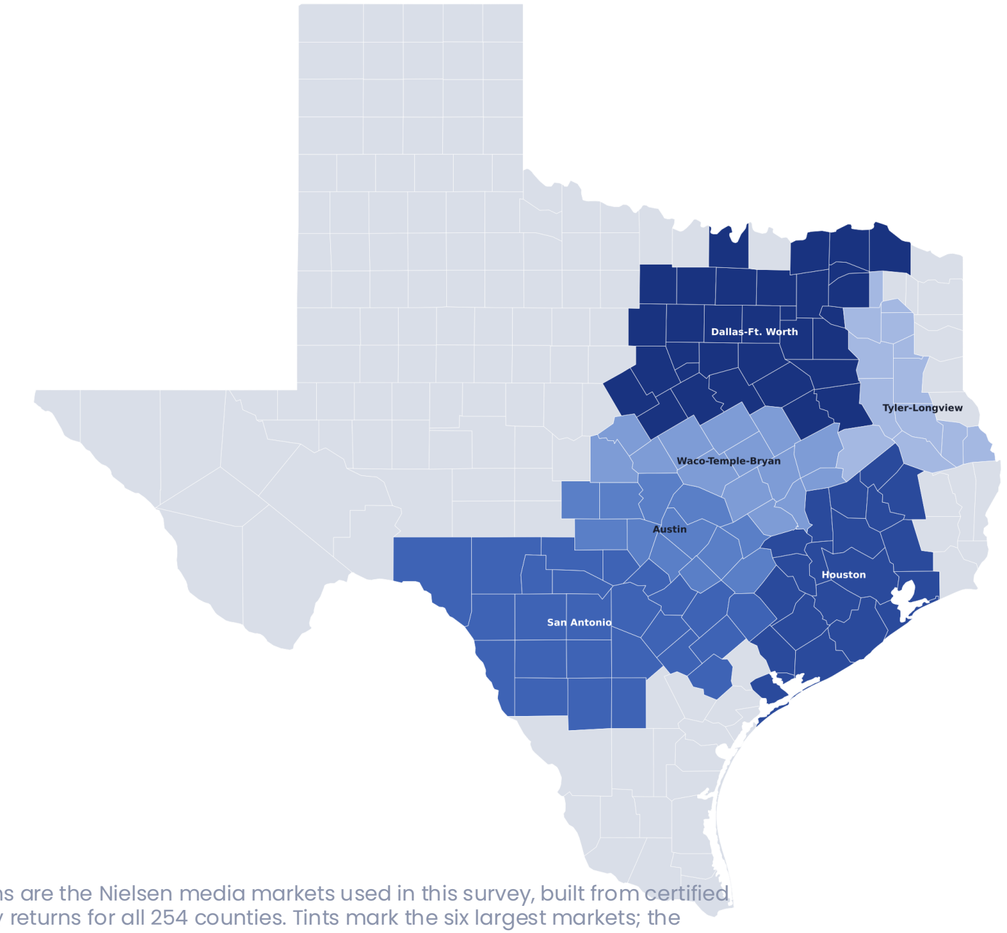
Regional map and statewide benchmarks

BASES

Certified returns, 2008–2024; published polling averages

REGIONAL CONTEXT

Where Texas's vote comes from



Regions are the Nielsen media markets used in this survey, built from certified county returns for all 254 counties. Tints mark the six largest markets; the fourteen remaining markets are shown in grey as rest of state.

MARGIN BY REGION, 2020 AND 2024

REGION	SHARE	2020 PRESIDENT	2020 SENATE	2024 PRESIDENT	2024 SENATE	CRUZ VS. TRUMP
Statewide	100%	**R +5.6**	**R +9.6**	**R +13.7**	**R +8.5**	-5.2
Dallas–Ft. Worth	30%	R +4.4	R +9.6	R +11.9	**R +6.4**	-5.5
Houston	25%	R +1.6	R +5.9	R +9.3	**R +3.9**	-5.4
Austin	10%	D +20.7	D +15.6	D +14.2	**D +18.2**	-4.0
San Antonio	10%	R +0.4	R +5.3	R +9.2	**R +3.1**	-6.0
Waco–Temple–Bryan	4%	R +23.1	R +26.6	R +31.0	**R +26.7**	-4.2
Tyler–Longview	3%	R +46.5	R +47.7	R +51.9	**R +48.9**	-3.0
Rest of state	18%	R +20.5	R +22.0	R +31.4	**R +26.4**	-5.1
WITHIN THE DALLAS–FT. WORTH MARKET						
Dallas County	8%	D +31.6	D +25.1	D +22.2	**D +28.4**	-6.2
Tarrant County	7%	D +0.2	R +4.9	R +5.1	**D +0.2**	-5.3
Collin County	5%	R +4.3	R +11.6	R +11.1	**R +5.2**	-5.9
Denton County	4%	R +8.1	R +14.5	R +13.2	**R +8.3**	-4.8
Outer DFW	7%	R +53.9	R +55.4	R +54.6	**R +49.6**	-5.0

President: Biden–Trump 2020, Harris–Trump 2024. Senate: Hegar–Cornyn 2020, Allred–Cruz 2024. Democratic minus Republican share of all votes, from certified county returns. Cruz vs. Trump: Cruz's 2024 margin less Trump's; negative means Cruz ran behind. Share is the region's portion of the 2024 vote.

THE TWO BIG MARKETS

Dallas–Ft. Worth casts 30 percent of the vote and Houston 25. Both went Trump by 12 and 9 in 2024 and Cruz by 6 and 4. Dallas County is the Democratic base at D +22 to +28; Tarrant is even; outer DFW runs R +50.

WHERE CRUZ RAN BEHIND

Cruz trailed Trump by 5.2 points statewide in 2024 and by 3 to 6 in every market, widest in San Antonio (6.0) and Dallas–Ft. Worth (5.5). Allred's 8.5-point loss is the closest statewide result since 2018.

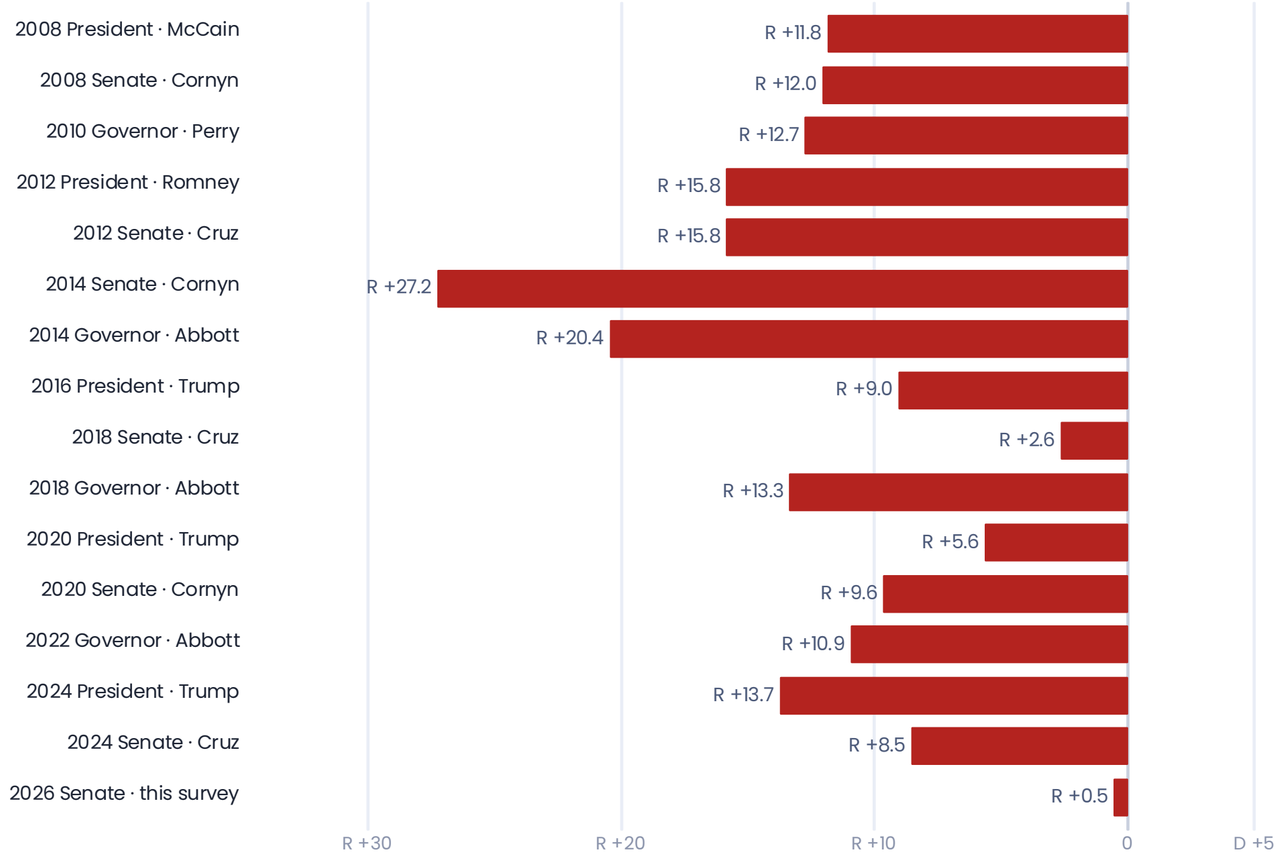
IN THIS SURVEY

Dallas–Ft. Worth goes Talarico 49 to 45 and Houston 49 to 46, each about ten points left of the 2024 Senate margin. Austin is Talarico +17 against Allred +18; the rest of the state is Paxton +16 against Cruz +26.

HISTORICAL BENCHMARKS

A red state narrowed to even; a race the polls call Talarico +3

STATEWIDE MARGIN, WINNING PARTY, POINTS



PUBLISHED POLLING AVERAGES

SOURCE	PAXTON	TALARICO	MARGIN
Quantus Insights Oct 9–11 · this survey	**47.2**	**46.7**	**Paxton +0.5**
RealClearPolling Polls through Oct 8	45.1	48.1	Talarico +3.0
Decision Desk HQ As of Oct 12	44.5	47.8	Talarico +3.3
270toWin Latest poll Oct 3	45.6	49.6	Talarico +4.0
FiftyPlusOne As of Oct 13	45.0	48.5	Talarico +3.5
Pollsmax As of Oct 8	45.0	47.6	Talarico +2.6
Average of averages Five aggregators	**45.0**	**48.3**	**Talarico +3.3**

Aggregator averages as updated October 3 to October 13, 2026. Shares in percent. Cook Political Report and Sabato's Crystal Ball rate the race Toss Up; Inside Elections rates it Lean Republican.

THE BENCHMARK

Texas has voted Republican in every statewide race since 1994: Trump by 9.0 in 2016, 5.6 in 2020 and 13.7 in 2024. The closest result of the period was Cruz's 2.6-point win over O'Rourke in 2018; Cruz won by 8.5 in 2024.

THE CANDIDATE RECORD

Paxton won three terms as Attorney General, by 20.8, 3.6 and 9.8, and took the May 26 runoff over Cornyn 63.8 to 36.2. Talarico, a state representative since 2019, won the March 3 primary over Crockett with 52 percent.

AGAINST THE AVERAGES

Paxton's 47.2 is above the aggregators' 44.5 to 45.6; Talarico's 46.7 is below their 47.6 to 49.6. Paxton +0.5 against Talarico +3.3 is a 3.8-point gap, inside the ±7.2 margin on a difference.

SECTION THREE

Favorability, fit and the 2024 baseline

How likely voters see the two nominees, whether each is in line with most Texans, and how the sample recalls its 2024 presidential vote, each with demographic detail.

QUESTIONS

Q2, Q3, Q5, Q6, Q7

STRUCTURE

Topline result and demographic detail

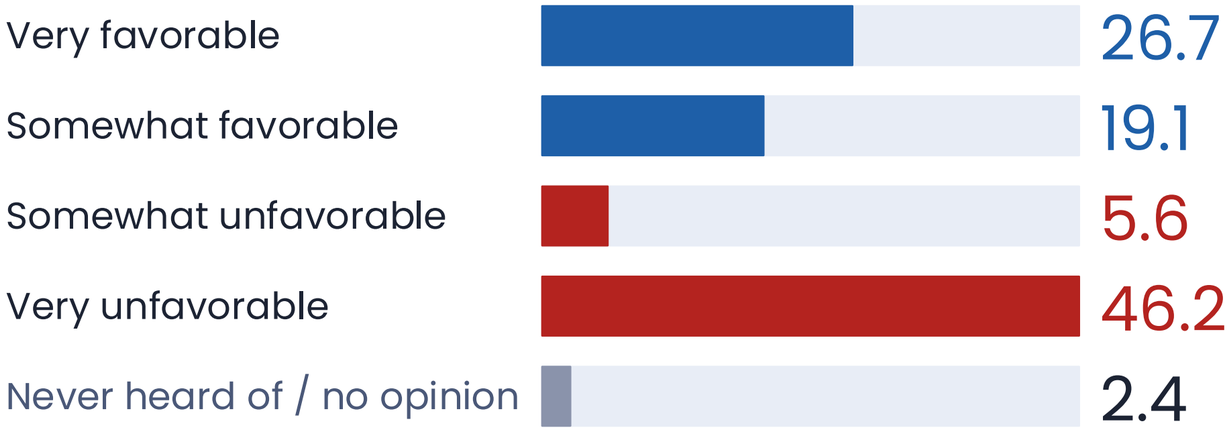
BASES

n = 839 voters-only base

Q3 · KEN PAXTON FAVORABILITY

Is your opinion of Ken Paxton favorable or unfavorable?

Net -6.0
Paxton favorable minus unfavorable



FAVORABLE VS. UNFAVORABLE



-6.0 net favorability, Paxton

NET FAVORABILITY BY GROUP

Women	Net -16
Men	Net +6
Independents	Net -27
Urban	Net -35
Rural	Net +31

UNDERWATER

Paxton is 45.8 favorable to 51.8 unfavorable, net -6.0. Nearly half of likely voters, 46.2 percent, are very unfavorable, against 26.7 percent very favorable.

FULLY DEFINED

Only 2.4 percent have no opinion of Paxton or have never heard of him. Opinion is formed and polarized: 73 percent hold a strong view either way, and strong views run 46 to 27 against him.

REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the voters-only base of 839. Net is favorable minus unfavorable from unrounded shares; group nets from whole-number column percentages.

Q3 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

Is your opinion of Ken Paxton favorable or unfavorable?

GROUP	FAV.	UNFAV.	NONE	N
GENDER				
Women	41	57	2	442
Men	52	46	2	397
AGE				
18–29	30	62	8	87
30–44	40	58	2	194
45–64	50	48	2	307
65+	51	48	1	251
RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)				
White	53	45	1	484
Hispanic	34	62	4	209
Black	29	71	0	90
Other†	38†	53†	8†	20
Asian†	56†	36†	8†	36

GROUP	FAV.	UNFAV.	NONE	N
EDUCATION (MODELED)				
HS – Some College	52	46	2	494
College	41	56	2	221
Graduate School	29	66	5	124
PARTY ID (MODELED)				
Republican	83	15	2	374
Democrat	5	93	1	292
Independent	34	61	5	173
METRO TYPE				
Urban	32	67	2	290
Suburban	46	50	3	317
Rural	65	34	1	177
Town†	54†	42†	4†	55

MEDIA MARKET	FAV.	UNFAV.	NONE	N
MEDIA MARKET				
Dallas–Ft. Worth	36	62	2	261
Houston	50	45	4	197
Austin	33	66	0	87
San Antonio	51	47	2	86
Waco–Temple–Bryan†	53†	47†	0†	35
Tyler–Longview†	89†	11†	0†	22
Rest of state	54	43	4	151

GENDER GAP

Men are 52 favorable to 46 unfavorable on Paxton, net +6; women are 41 to 57, net -16. Voters 65 and over are the only age group net positive, 51 to 48; voters under 30 are 30 to 62.

PARTY

Republicans are 83 favorable to 15; Democrats 5 to 93. Independents split 34 favorable to 61 unfavorable. Rural voters are net +31, suburban voters net -4, urban voters net -35.

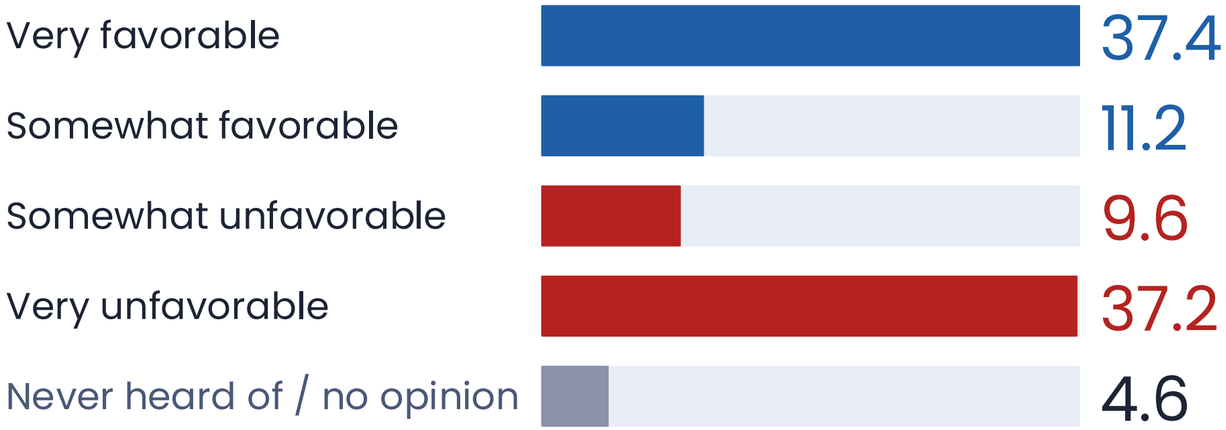
REPORTING NOTE

Whole-number column percentages. Fav. and Unfav. combine very and somewhat; None = never heard of or no opinion. † = base under 80. Rest of state combines the fourteen smallest markets.

Q4 · JAMES TALARICO FAVORABILITY

Is your opinion of James Talarico favorable or unfavorable?

Net +1.8
Talarico favorable minus unfavorable



FAVORABLE VS. UNFAVORABLE



+1.8 net favorability, Talarico

NET FAVORABILITY BY GROUP

Women	Net +16
Men	Net -13
Independents	Net +34
Urban	Net +19
Rural	Net -26

NARROWLY POSITIVE

Talarico is 48.6 favorable to 46.8 unfavorable, net +1.8. Strong views are split: 37.4 percent very favorable, 37.2 percent very unfavorable.

NEARLY AS WELL KNOWN

4.6 percent have no opinion of Talarico or have never heard of him, against Paxton's 2.4. His very-favorable share, 37.4, runs 10.7 points above Paxton's; his very-unfavorable share runs 9.0 below.

REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the voters-only base of 839. Net is favorable minus unfavorable from unrounded shares; group nets from whole-number column percentages.

Q4 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

Is your opinion of James Talarico favorable or unfavorable?

GROUP	FAV.	UNFAV.	NONE	N
GENDER				
Women	56	40	5	442
Men	41	54	5	397
AGE				
18–29	76	19	5	87
30–44	59	37	6	194
45–64	41	54	5	307
65+	40	57	3	251
RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)				
White	38	55	7	484
Hispanic	62	36	1	209
Black	71	28	0	90
Other†	64†	28†	7†	20
Asian†	44†	52†	4†	36

GROUP	FAV.	UNFAV.	NONE	N
EDUCATION (MODELED)				
HS – Some College	43	53	5	494
College	55	41	3	221
Graduate School	61	32	8	124
PARTY ID (MODELED)				
Republican	12	84	5	374
Democrat	87	10	4	292
Independent	64	30	6	173
METRO TYPE				
Urban	58	39	3	290
Suburban	50	45	5	317
Rural	34	60	5	177
Town†	41†	51†	9†	55

MEDIA MARKET	FAV.	UNFAV.	NONE	N
MEDIA MARKET				
Dallas–Ft. Worth	58	37	5	261
Houston	43	48	9	197
Austin	66	34	0	87
San Antonio	45	55	0	86
Waco–Temple–Bryan†	22†	70†	8†	35
Tyler–Longview†	11†	89†	0†	22
Rest of state	42	54	3	151

GENDER AND AGE

Women are 56 favorable to 40 unfavorable on Talarico, net +16; men are 41 to 54, net -13. Voters under 30 are 76 to 19; voters 65 and over are 40 to 57.

PARTY AND PLACE

Democrats are 87 favorable to 10; Republicans 12 to 84. Independents are 64 favorable to 30, net +34. Urban voters are net +19, suburban voters net +5, rural voters net -26.

REPORTING NOTE

Whole-number column percentages. Fav. and Unfav. combine very and somewhat; None = never heard of or no opinion. † = base under 80. Rest of state combines the fourteen smallest markets.

Q5 + Q6 · IN LINE WITH MOST TEXANS

Regardless of your vote, are each nominee's views and values in line with most Texans, or out of step?

Paxton +0.9 · Talarico -2.8

net in line, each nominee

Q6 · KEN PAXTON



Q5 · JAMES TALARICO



NET IN LINE BY GROUP (IN LINE MINUS OUT OF STEP)

	Women	Men	18–29	65+	White	Hispanic	Black	Independents	Urban	Suburban	Rural
Paxton	−10	+13	−36	+12	+19	−13	−59	−25	−19	+2	+27
Talarico	+9	−16	+38	−19	−19	+7	+60	+16	+24	−1	−43

Red figures: Paxton net in line; blue figures: Talarico net in line; grey figures are net out of step. Whole-number column percentages; 18–29 n=87.

PAXTON

48.6 percent say Paxton's views and values are in line with most Texans and 47.7 say out of step, net +0.9, even though his favorability is net -6.0. Only 3.7 percent are unsure.

TALARICO

45.5 percent say Talarico is in line and 48.3 out of step, net -2.8, even though his favorability is net +1.8; 6.3 percent do not know enough about him. Independents call him in line by 16.

REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the voters-only base of 839. Net in line is in line minus out of step. Both questions were asked regardless of vote intention.

Q5 + Q6 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

In line with most Texans or out of step: Paxton (Q6) and Talarico (Q5), by group.

GROUP	PAX IN	PAX OUT	TAL IN	TAL OUT	N
GENDER					
Women	43	53	51	42	442
Men	55	42	39	55	397
AGE					
18–29	29	65	65	27	87
30–44	44	54	51	42	194
45–64	52	43	43	51	307
65+	55	43	38	57	251
RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)					
White	58	39	38	57	484
Hispanic	41	54	50	43	209
Black	18	77	75	15	90
Other†	36†	60†	61†	33†	20
Asian†	54†	42†	41†	53†	36

GROUP	PAX IN	PAX OUT	TAL IN	TAL OUT	N
EDUCATION (MODELED)					
HS – Some College	54	42	39	55	494
College	43	53	54	42	221
Graduate School	37	59	56	34	124
PARTY ID (MODELED)					
Republican	90	7	6	87	374
Democrat	4	92	90	4	292
Independent	35	60	56	40	173
METRO TYPE					
Urban	38	57	58	34	290
Suburban	49	47	46	47	317
Rural	63	36	26	69	177
Town†	59†	38†	35†	61†	55

MEDIA MARKET	PAX IN	PAX OUT	TAL IN	TAL OUT	N
MEDIA MARKET					
Dallas–Ft. Worth	40	57	58	39	261
Houston	48	47	46	47	197
Austin	36	59	53	39	87
San Antonio	53	45	36	55	86
Waco–Temple–Bryan†	55†	38†	29†	61†	35
Tyler–Longview†	83†	17†	9†	86†	22
Rest of state	62	34	33	59	151

GENDER AND AGE

Men call Paxton in line 55 to 42 and Talarico out of step 55 to 39; women say the reverse, Talarico in line 51 to 42 and Paxton out of step 53 to 43. Voters under 30 call Talarico in line 65 to 27.

PARTY AND PLACE

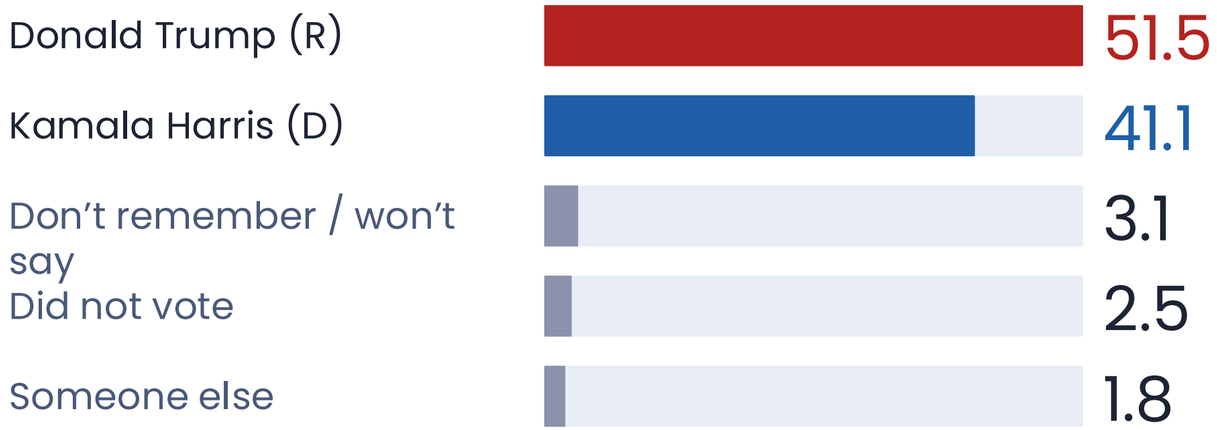
Republicans call Paxton in line 90 to 7; Democrats call Talarico in line 90 to 4. Independents: Talarico in line 56 to 40, Paxton out of step 60 to 35. Rural voters: Paxton in line 63 to 36.

REPORTING NOTE

Whole-number column percentages; not sure not shown. In = in line with most Texans, Out = out of step. † = base under 80. Rest of state combines the fourteen smallest markets.

Q7 · 2024 PRESIDENTIAL VOTE RECALL

In the 2024 election for president, who did you vote for?



Trump +10.4

Trump margin, recalled 2024 vote

TWO-WAY SHARE, RECALLED



13.7

point margin, Trump, certified 2024 result

RECALLED MARGIN BY GROUP

Women	Harris +3
Men	Trump +25
Independents	Trump +4
Suburban	Trump +16
Rural	Trump +38

THE BASELINE

Respondents recall a 51.5 to 41.1 Trump vote, a 10.4-point margin. Texas’s certified 2024 result was Trump 56.1 to Harris 42.5, a 13.7-point margin; Cruz won the Senate race by 8.5.

WHAT IT MEANS

The sample recalls a margin 3.3 points narrower than the certified result, within the usual variance of a winner’s margin and potential swing from 2024 among recalled voters. The sample sits on a Trump +10 electorate; the Paxton +0.5 ballot is a ten-point swing from it.

REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the voters-only base of 839. Certified result from the Texas Secretary of State; recall typically understates the winner’s margin.

Q7 · DEMOGRAPHIC DETAIL

In the 2024 election for president, who did you vote for?

GROUP	TRUMP	HARRIS	NEITHER	N
GENDER				
Women	46	49	6	442
Men	58	33	8	397
AGE				
18–29	43	48	8	87
30–44	46	44	10	194
45–64	53	41	6	307
65+	57	37	6	251
RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)				
White	60	34	6	484
Hispanic	49	41	11	209
Black	11	80	9	90
Other†	54†	42†	4†	20
Asian†	51†	42†	7†	36

GROUP	TRUMP	HARRIS	NEITHER	N
EDUCATION (MODELED)				
HS – Some College	56	37	7	494
College	47	45	8	221
Graduate School	42	51	7	124
PARTY ID (MODELED)				
Republican	90	3	6	374
Democrat	5	88	8	292
Independent	47	43	9	173
METRO TYPE				
Urban	38	52	10	290
Suburban	54	38	8	317
Rural	68	30	2	177
Town†	60†	37†	3†	55

MEDIA MARKET	TRUMP	HARRIS	NEITHER	N
MEDIA MARKET				
Dallas–Ft. Worth	50	46	5	261
Houston	52	41	8	197
Austin	44	56	1	87
San Antonio	49	41	10	86
Waco–Temple–Bryan†	70†	22†	8†	35
Tyler–Longview†	70†	22†	8†	22
Rest of state	53	33	14	151

GENDER GAP

Men recall Trump by 25 points and now back Paxton by 12; women recall Harris by 3 and back Talarico by 10. Every age group recalls Trump except voters under 30, who recall Harris by 5.

PARTY AND PLACE

Republicans recall Trump 90 to 3; Democrats recall Harris 88 to 5. Independents recall Trump 47 to 43 and now back Talarico 52 to 37. Hispanic voters recall Trump 49 to 41 and back Talarico 55 to 37.

REPORTING NOTE

Whole-number column percentages. Neither combines someone else, did not vote and don't remember. † = base under 80; race and education are modeled from the voter file. Rest of state combines the fourteen smallest markets.

BASES AND MARGIN OF ERROR

What each number can carry.

ANALYSIS BASE	95% MARGIN OF ERROR	REPORTABLE
854 full study	±3.6 pts	Yes
300 to 400	±5.3 to ±6.1 pts	Yes
150 to 250	±6.7 to ±8.7 pts	Yes, with base
80 to 149	±8.7 to ±11.9 pts	Directional
Under 80	wider than ±11.9 pts	Transparency only

Margins are calculated at the 95 percent confidence level for an estimate near 50 percent and include the survey design effect of 1.18. Subgroups marked † should be interpreted as directional. The margin on a difference between two candidates is roughly twice the single-share margin, about ±7.2.

QUESTION BASES

Q1 · U.S. Senate ballot	**n=839**
Q2 · Ken Paxton favorability	**n=839**
Q3 · James Talarico favorability	**n=839**
Q4 · Who the people you know will vote for	**n=839**
Q5 · Talarico in line or out of step	**n=839**
Q6 · Paxton in line or out of step	**n=839**
Q7 · 2024 presidential vote recall	**n=839**

SMALL BASES IN THIS WAVE

Town Metro type	n=56
Waco–Temple–Bryan Media market	n=36
Tyler–Longview (Lfkn & Ncgd) Media market	n=19
Fourteen smallest markets Media market · 147 respondents combined, none above 26	n≤26
Asian Race / ethnicity (modeled)	n=36
Other Race / ethnicity (modeled)	n=19
18–29 Age · reportable, directional	n=87

QUESTION BASES

Every question, from the Senate ballot through the recall question, was asked of the voters-only base of 839 likely voters.

DIFFERENCES

The margin on a difference between two candidates is roughly ±7.2 points; a lead inside it is an edge, not decisive.

REPORTING NOTE

Design effect 1.18; effective sample size 724. Every question uses the voters-only base of 839; the sample profile uses all 854.

AT A GLANCE

The headline figures

Paxton +0.5

U.S. Senate ballot, full sample

Talarico +15

Ballot margin among independents

Talarico +10

Ballot margin among women

Paxton +12

Ballot margin among men

Talarico +26

Ballot margin among urban voters

Paxton +34

Ballot margin among rural voters

Paxton +5

Ballot margin among suburban voters

Trump +10.4

Recalled 2024 vote; certified Trump +13.7

A STATISTICAL TIE

Paxton leads by 0.5, well inside the roughly ±7.2 margin on a difference. He holds men, white voters, rural voters and voters 45 and over; Talarico holds women, Hispanic and Black voters, urban voters and voters under 45.

WHERE IT IS DECIDED

Independents, a fifth of the sample, back Talarico 52 to 37 with 9 percent undecided. The suburbs are 50 Paxton to 45; Dallas–Ft. Worth is Talarico +4 and Houston +3. Paxton is net -6.0 on favorability; Talarico net +1.8.

REPORTING NOTE

Margins are computed from unrounded topline shares and may differ by a tenth from the rounded figures shown; group margins are differences in whole-number column percentages.

CONTACT

Questions, crosstabs and media requests

Prior releases and our polling archive are posted on the website.

PREPARED BY

Jason B. Corley

Co-founder and Lead Pollster
Quantus Insights

EMAIL

contact@quantusinsights.org

WEBSITE

quantusinsights.org

X / TWITTER

@QuantusInsights

FIELD DATES

October 9–11, 2026